

Beyond the Hype: What 1,000 Startups' Revenue Really Tells Us

A category-level inference study on trailing revenue windows, growth momentum, and monetization efficiency

1,000

startups tracked

19

categories analyzed

4

trailing revenue windows

The Dataset & How We Read It

29 fields per startup — revenue, audience, pricing, category, and marketplace signals

1

1,000 startups, 19 usable categories

726 of 1,000 startups carry a category tag; this analysis keeps the 19 categories with 10+ startups (672 companies) so averages aren't skewed by one-off entries.

2

Four trailing revenue windows

Each startup reports cumulative revenue for the trailing 30 days, 3 months, 12 months, and all-time — not sequential monthly buckets.

3

Built for comparison, not vanity totals

Raw totals reward category size. We normalize every window to a monthly rate before comparing categories.

OUR TWO GROWTH SIGNALS

Momentum

Last-30-day revenue ÷ average monthly revenue over the last 3 months.

> 1.0 → this month is running hotter than the recent quarter

Trend

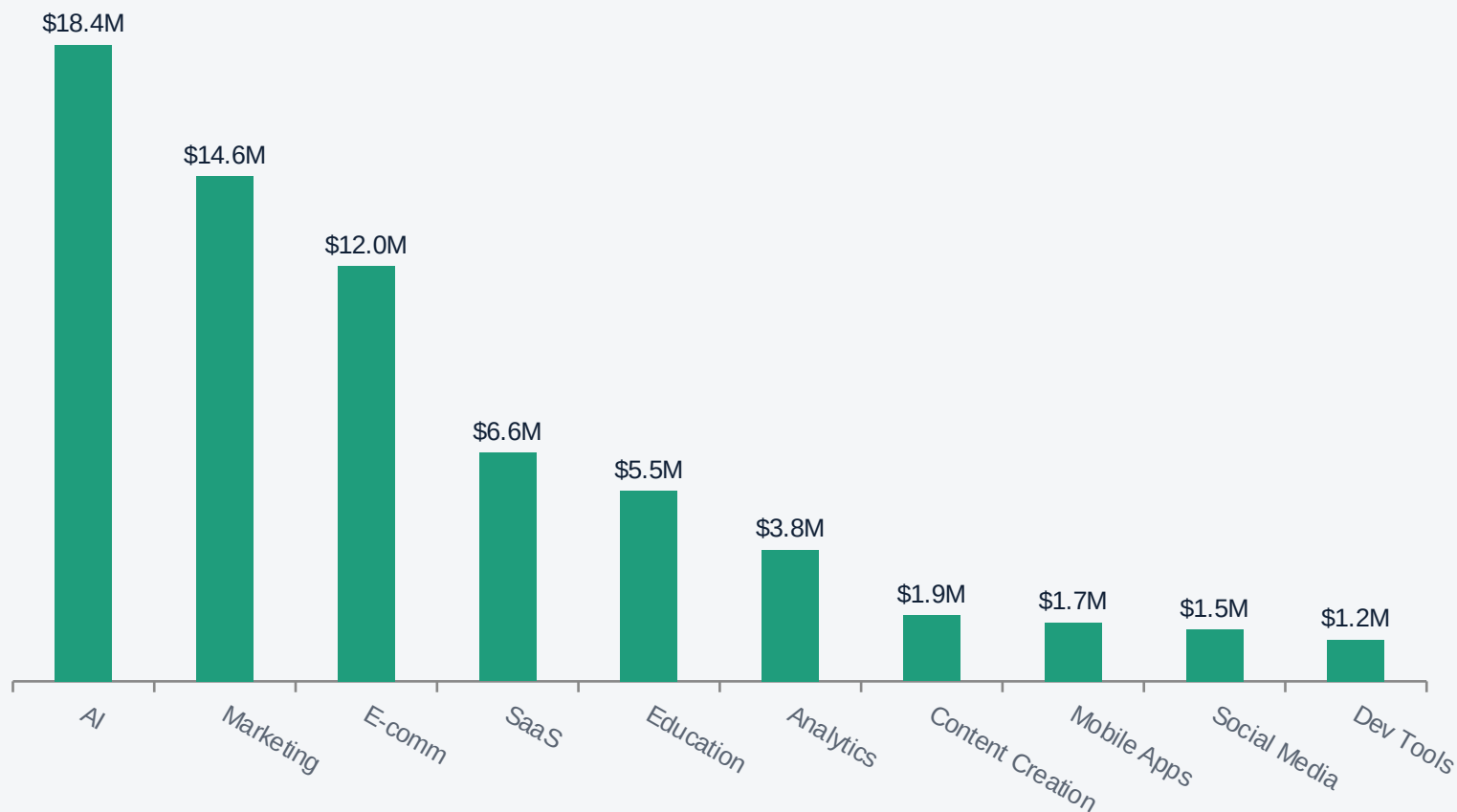
Average monthly revenue over the last 3 months ÷ average monthly revenue over the last 12 months.

> 1.0 → the category is compounding over the full year

Together they separate a category that's genuinely accelerating from one that's coasting on old wins.

Revenue Is Extremely Concentrated

Trailing 12-month revenue by category, across 672 categorized startups



63%

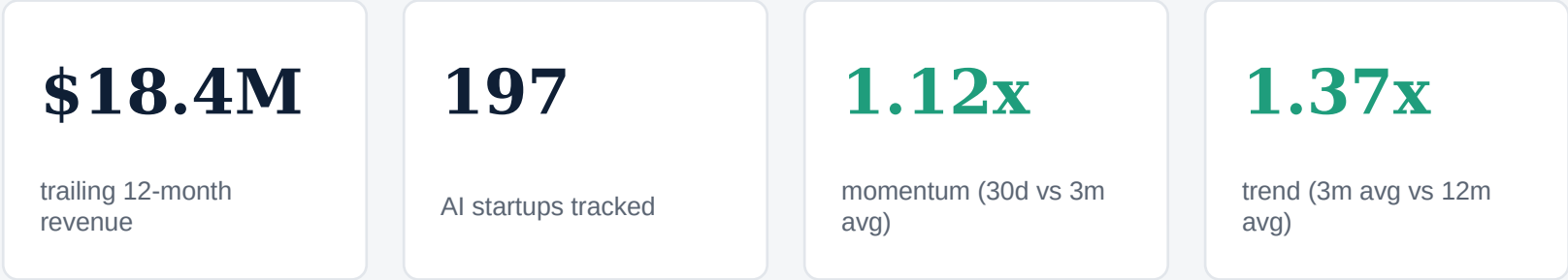
of all tracked revenue comes from just 3 categories

AI · Marketing · E-commerce

AI alone accounts for 25.8% of tracked revenue with more than triple the startup count (197) of any other category — scale and popularity are moving together.

AI Isn't Just Big — It's Compounding

The category leads on every window, and is still accelerating on top of that lead



Spotlight: the AI startups driving it

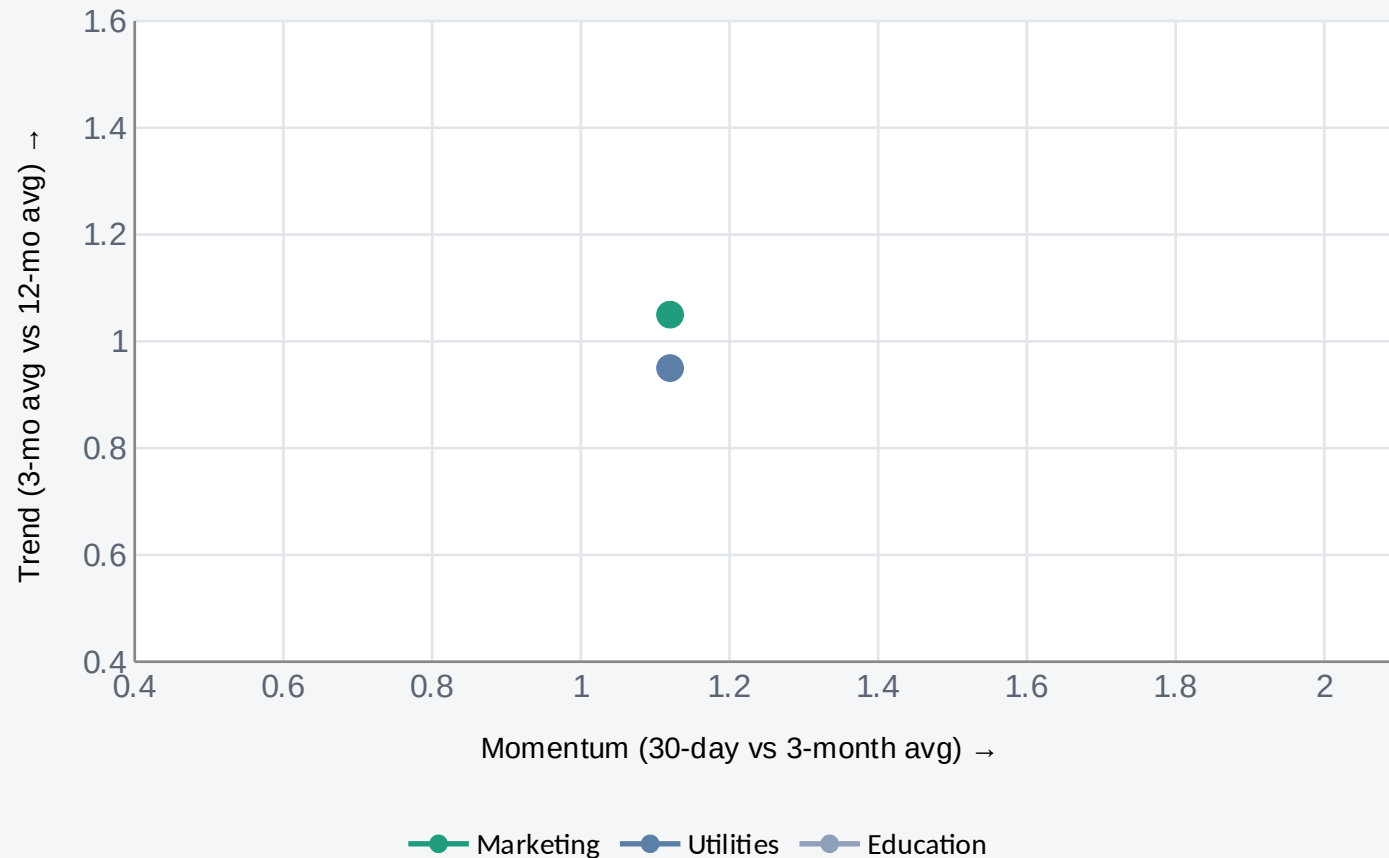
STARTUP	12-MONTH REVENUE	LAST 30 DAYS
Comp AI	\$3.94M	\$575K
Rezi	\$2.98M	\$242K
GojiberryAI	\$1.54M	\$386K

Why this matters

A category can lead on total revenue purely by having more startups. AI leads on total revenue AND on both growth ratios — its lead is widening, not just large.

Almost Every Category Is Accelerating — Education Is the Exception

Momentum (recent 30 days) vs. Trend (recent quarter vs. full year), by category



EDUCATION

Trend = 0.58x

the only category among the top 18 where the recent quarter's monthly average sits below the full year's — revenue is cooling on a 12-month view.

Momentum = 1.95x

but the very last 30 days spiked well above that cooling average — a volatile, uneven recovery rather than steady growth. See next slide.

Inside Education: A Few Early Winners Are Cooling Off

Top Education startups by trailing 12-month revenue

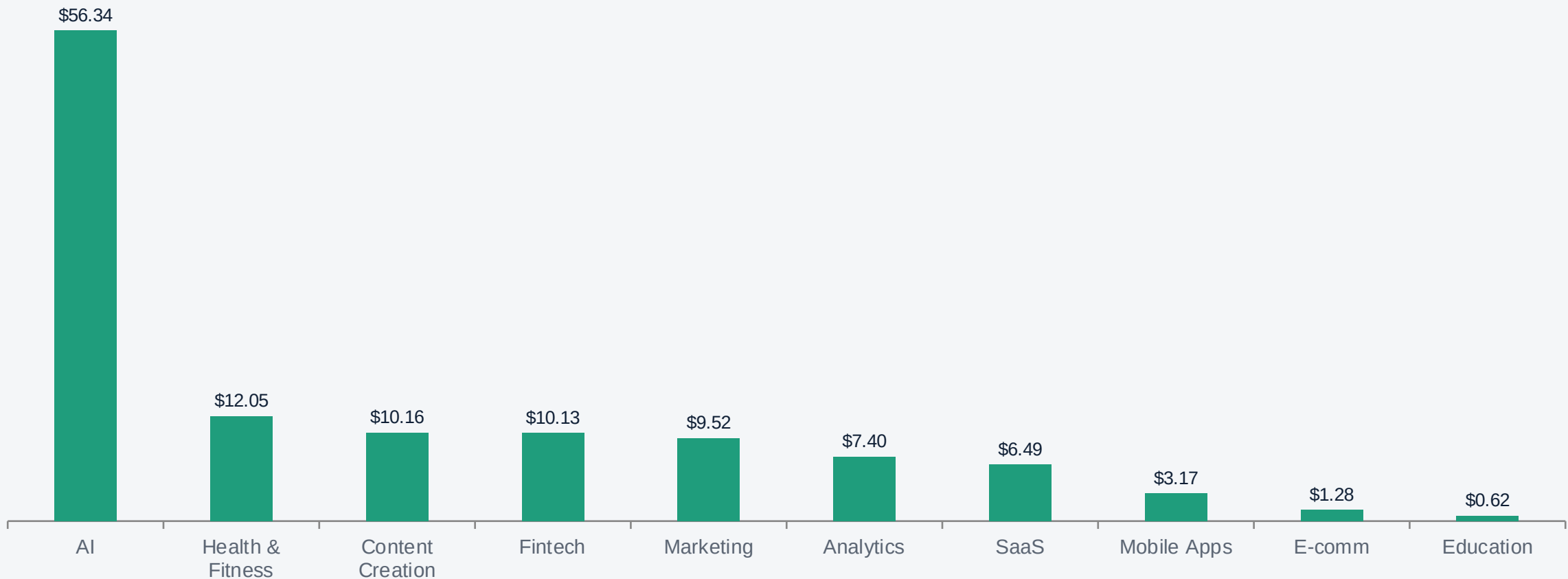
STARTUP	12-MONTH REV.	3-MONTH REV.	30-DAY REV.	30d GROWTH
Kibu	\$1.85M	\$0	\$200K	-25.6%
DataExpert / TechCreator	\$1.47M	\$226K	\$82K	-4.0%
Codédex	\$844K	\$233K	\$77K	+0.4%
Lunchbreak	\$557K	\$106K	\$31K	-8.9%
MagicSlides.app	\$215K	\$35K	\$10K	-15.5%

Read:

Kibu and DataExpert together hold ~60% of the category's 12-month revenue but both show negative 30-day growth. Education's overall “recent spike” (previous slide) is smaller, less-established startups picking up share while the early leaders decelerate — a hand-off, not broad-based strength.

Traffic Doesn't Convert to Revenue Equally

Average revenue earned per visitor in the last 30 days, by category (categories with 3+ reporting startups)



AI monetizes visitors ~90x more efficiently than Education and ~44x more than E-commerce — its lead isn't just about traffic volume, it's about converting that traffic into paid revenue.

Takeaways

1

Winners keep winning

AI leads on total revenue, momentum, trend, and monetization efficiency at once — its advantage is compounding, not plateauing.

2

Watch cooling leaders, not just hot categories

Education looks healthy in aggregate 12-month revenue, but its two biggest startups (Kibu, DataExpert) are already shrinking month-over-month.

3

Concentration is the norm

Just 3 of 19 categories generate 63% of tracked revenue — category choice matters as much as execution.

4

Revenue per visitor is a hidden differentiator

Two categories with similar traffic can produce wildly different revenue; monetization model matters more than raw audience size.

Limitations: only 726/1,000 startups carry a category tag; “revenue per visitor” relies on self-reported traffic present for just 178 startups; trailing windows can shift sharply from single large contracts (e.g., Kibu’s \$0 three-month figure against a \$1.85M twelve-month figure).

Thank You

Questions & Discussion